

Figure 5: You have created three text files. Blaze detects a pattern

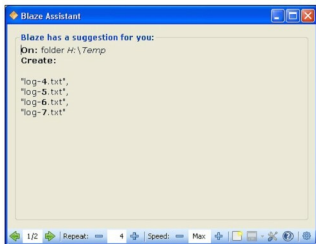


Figure 6 : Blaze prompts you to create more files with a similar pattern

email <email address> " <subject line> " <body of the message>".

Example: email someone@yahoo.com "Mobile" "Please send me your mobile number."

This command will take you to the e-mail client, with the right text placed in each field and waiting for you to click 'Send'.

Execute a command at the DOS prompt

There are times when command line utilities are very handy, such as *ipconfig*, ping or writing a small batch file. To execute a command at the DOS prompt, you can start the command with '>' (greater than) inside Blaze, and you will get the command prompt window with the output.

An additional cool feature in Blaze is the recognition of context (directory) that is open in Windows Explorer. When you have the Explorer window open, the same CMD command you execute from Blaze, will be executed in the context of the current directory. For example, when you are in the 'My Documents' folder and if you type:

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>find "ubuntu" *.pdf
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...you will get a DOS window with search results from the documents folder, which have the string 'ubuntu' in them.

Advanced Blaze

Blaze comes with a few advanced features that automate many of your routine tasks, making them painless. It has the capability of recording the user's interactions and generating a script out of it.

Record and replay

During the day, there will be routine operations such as logging into the corporate VPN network or starting the dial-up/broadband connection, which could involve several clicks and keystrokes. You can let Blaze learn that just by typing 'record macro' and performing the operations that you plan to record, once. When you are done with all the steps, invoke Blaze (Ctrl+Alt+Space). Now Blaze asks you to type the script name. So you have just created a Python script without manually writing a single line of code! Your script name is the new Blaze command. Next time onwards, Blaze will perform the operation just by entering the script name.

If you are a programmer who wants to modify or tweak the Python script, you can visit the scripts folder by typing 'Scripts folder'. You will find one or two Python scripts, which come as part of the installation that is already in that folder.

Learn and suggest

Blaze is active even when the pop-up window is not active/open. It is constantly monitoring in the background and if you look carefully, you will find the colour of the Blaze icon in the taskbar changes colour to yellow. The colour change happens when the utility detects a keystroke or an operation pattern. For example, if you have created three files in a folder (say *log-1.txt*, *log-2.txt*, *log-3.txt*), Blaze identifies a pattern and asks if you want to create files *log-4.txt* to *log-n.txt* (where 'n' can be whatever number you want). After the Blaze icon turns yellow, to see the suggestion, you need to press *CapsLock* twice, which will display the Blaze Assistant window (see Figure 6).

Another intelligent feature in Blaze is identifying patterns and not just simple sequences like 1, 2, 3... For example, in Windows Explorer, when you delete files that have a pattern (in the beginning, the middle or the end), Blaze can detect this pattern. It will ask you if you want to delete the remaining files that match the pattern. After it asks you that, you still have the option to select all or even edit the list of files on which that operation is not required.

In the given example, I have manually deleted files that have 'one' in the filename. I have deleted 'sample-one.txt', 'twenty-one.txt' and 'simple-sample-one.txt'. Among these files, Blaze detects that 'one' is common. It suggests deleting the rest of the files in the same directory.